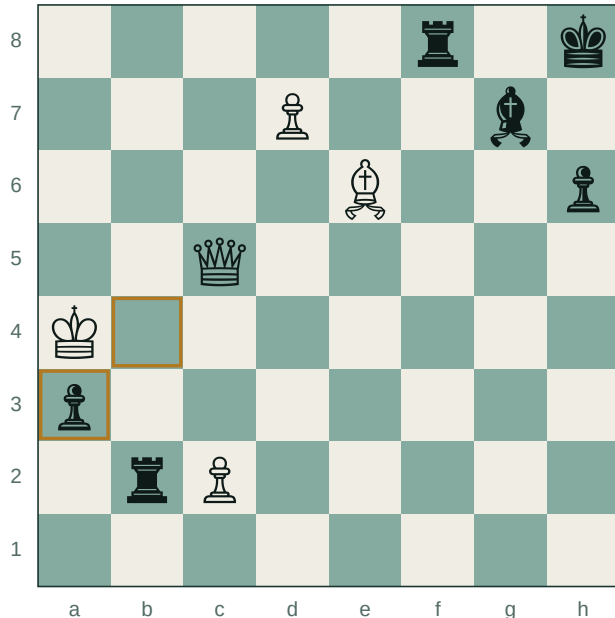


Promotion combinations: White, move 45

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 44...bxa3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45. Qxf8+ Bxf8 46. d8=Q Rb4+ 47. Ka5

45.Qxf8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f8 it attacks king on h8 and bishop on g7. Recorded reply: **45...Bxf8**.

46.d8=Q The pawn moves from d7 to d8. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **46...Rb4+**.

47.Ka5 The king moves from a4 to a5.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.